



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

yogamāyāsahasrākṣo virūpākṣo mahāmanāḥ | BRP226.026.1
vācā mitrajanaślāghī jñātibandhujanapriyaḥ || 26 || BRP226.026.2
kṣamāvāṃś cānaḥṃvādī sa devo brahmadāyakaḥ | BRP226.027.1
bhayahartā bhayārtānām mitrānandavivardhanaḥ || 27 || BRP226.027.2

— Brahmapurāṇa, Chapter 226: Dialogue between Śiva and the sages (Chapter 226), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This passage from the Brahmapurāṇa offers a glimpse into the divine qualities of Śiva, presented in a way that resonates deeply with the human experience. It speaks of a being adorned with "yogamāyāsahasrākṣo," suggesting both the power of illusion and a thousand eyes, representing the ability to perceive the universe in its entirety, beyond the limitations of ordinary sight. Virūpākṣo, the one with extraordinary eyes, implies a vision that transcends the mundane, seeing truth where others see only appearances. Mahāmanāḥ, the great-minded one, signifies an expansive consciousness, free from petty concerns and filled with compassion.

The passage continues, describing Śiva as "vācā mitrajanaślāghī," praising good people with words, and "jñātibandhujanapriyaḥ," dear to relatives and friends. This highlights the importance of positive communication and nurturing relationships, qualities that we can all cultivate in our own lives. By speaking kindly and fostering connection, we mirror this divine attribute. The verses then proclaim, "kṣamāvāṃś cānaḥṃvādī," forgiving and free from ego, and "sa devo brahmadāyakaḥ," that divine being, bestower of Brahman, the ultimate reality. Here, forgiveness and humility are presented as pathways to spiritual realization. Letting go of ego allows us to connect with something larger than ourselves.

"Bhayahartā bhayārtānām," remover of fear for the fearful, and "mitrānandavivardhanaḥ," increasing the joy of friends, reveal Śiva as a source of comfort and happiness. This speaks to the power of empathy and the importance of supporting others through difficult times. By offering solace and sharing joy, we embody the divine's capacity to alleviate suffering and spread positivity.

In modern life, these qualities serve as guideposts on our own spiritual journeys. You can strive to see beyond surface appearances, cultivate kindness in your speech, practice forgiveness, let go of ego, and offer support to those in need. By embodying these virtues, you move closer to realizing your own inherent divinity and contributing to a more compassionate world. The passage encourages you to consider how you can embody these divine qualities in your daily interactions, transforming ordinary moments into opportunities for spiritual growth.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can I actively cultivate one of these qualities of Shiva in my interactions today, and what impact might that have on my relationships and my own inner peace?